17.2.3 Using concrete requests to ground analysis

ACME learned early that AI-assisted policy analysis works best when it's based on concrete examples instead of abstract descriptions. Rather than asking broad questions like "Who can see customer documents?", engineers focus discussions on specific requests and the expected results.

For example, a team might ask:

> *"What would change if this request were made outside business hours?"*
>
> *"Which policy is responsible for denying access when the requester is not a workspace member?"*

By tying analysis to real requests, the AI was forced to reason within the limits of the actual model. When responses included entities, actions, or attributes that were not present in the schema, it was immediately obvious that the analysis had strayed. Concrete examples kept both the AI and the human reviewer aligned with the actual system.

17.2.4 Human judgment remains central

Throughout this process, ACME treated AI output as advisory. The AI could explain behaviors, suggest changes, and refactor policy expressions, but it could not decide which policies to accept. That responsibility stayed with the human author, who was accountable for understanding and defending the resulting behavior.

This distinction mattered in practice. Many policy changes that are functionally correct still poorly communicate authority. Some obscure intent. Others introduce future risk by overfitting to a single case. Recognizing these issues requires understanding organizational norms, risk tolerance, and potential future developments. These judgments cannot be delegated to an AI language model.

The common thread in these examples is that AI accelerates understanding. It assists teams in explaining existing behavior, exploring alternatives, and